

3.1.5 Area of study 4: Music for theatre

For the purpose of this specification, music for theatre is defined as music composed to govern, enhance or support a theatrical conception from 1925 to the present.

Named composers

- Kurt Weill
- Richard Rodgers
- Stephen Sondheim
- Claude-Michel Schönberg
- Jason Robert Brown

Musical elements

The following table contains all the musical elements, for this area of study, that students must know and understand to answer questions in section A (Listening) and section C (Essay) of the exam. Marks will also be awarded for knowledge of other terms, if relevant to this area of study, in section C (Essay) of the exam.

Element type	Element
Melody	• pitch bend • melisma, syllabic • slide • glissando • leitmotif • angular.
Harmony	• power chords • sus4 chords • chord extensions – secondary 7th, 9th, 11th, 13th • other complex chords eg half diminished 7th, added 6th • chord symbols eg C/E, C⁷, C^ø and C⁺.
Structure	• intro/outro • bridge • verse • chorus • instrumental • middle 8.
Sonority (Timbre)	• studio/technological effects eg reverb • standard orchestral instruments • standard contemporary instrumental types eg electric guitar, synthesisers • vocal timbres eg falsetto, belt, rap • specific instrumental techniques eg slap bass, tremolo.
Texture	• a cappella • colla voce.
Tempo, metre and rhythm	• bpm (beats per minute) • mm (metronome marking) • irregular metre.